

26STCV10059 26STCV10059

County: los-angeles

Division: Civil Law and Motion

Department: 9

Hearing date: 2026-07-13

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Case Number: 26STCV10059 Hearing Date: July 13, 2026 Dept: 9

The Court hereby

distributes a tentative Minute Order for the July 13, 2026 ISC. The parties are welcome to provide input and propose modifications to any aspect of the minute order at the Initial Status Conference. If all parties submit on the tentative minute order prior to the commencement of the July 13, 2026 ISC, the Court will adopt the tentative minute order, and the parties need not appear. However, if there is any matter that any party would like to discuss, including any proposed change to this tentative minute order, that party should not submit on this tentative but instead appear at the ISC to raise the issue.

To avoid a failure to appear, please make sure to check in with Department 9 court staff and wait for the case to be called unless you receive notification that all parties have submitted on the tentative minute order.

MIGUEL ESPARZA vs SUBPAC, INC.,
26STCV10059

[TENTATIVE] MINUTE
ORDER

All Defendants are

ordered to file a timely Notice of Appearance within 30 days of service of the operative Summons and Complaint on them.

If any named

Defendant fails to timely respond to service of the operative Summons and Complaint by filing a Notice of Appearance, Plaintiff must timely seek and obtain entry of default against all such named Defendants who fail to timely

file a Notice of Appearance.

The Court reminds

the parties that ultimately, the Court may not enter default judgment in an amount exceeding the amount demanded in the Complaint. (CCP 585(b).)

The Court may not grant relief not demanded in the complaint by default judgment even though that relief otherwise would have been proper. (CCP § 580(a); *Airs Aromatics, LLC v. CBL Data Recovery Technologies, Inc.*

(2018) 23 Cal.App.5th 1013, 1018 (default judgment for sum in excess of that demanded in complaint is void). “It is

fundamental to the concept of due process that a defendant be given notice of the existence of a lawsuit and notice of the specific relief which is sought in the complaint served upon him.” (*Marriage of Lippel* (1990) 51 Cal.3d 1160, 1166 [emphasis added].) Accordingly,

prior to seeking any Defendant's default, Plaintiff may wish to review the operative Complaint to determine whether the operative Complaint gives notice of the amount of damages that Plaintiff seeks to recover in the event of a default judgment; if the operative Complaint fails to do so, it may be futile for Plaintiff to seek entry of Defendant's default without first amending the

Complaint to clearly state and give notice of the amount of damages that Plaintiff is seeking to recover in the event of a default judgment. In the event that Plaintiff wishes to amend the Complaint for this purpose, the Court hereby lifts the stay to grant Plaintiff leave to file an amended complaint. If

Defendant again fails to respond upon being served with the amended complaint, a request for entry of Defendant's default on the Amended Complaint may then possibly lead to a request for entry of default judgment in an amount equal to or less than that stated in the Amended Complaint. To be clear, the Court is not ordering Plaintiff to amend the operative Complaint; if, after considering the above, Plaintiff voluntarily wishes to amend the operative Complaint to give notice of the amount of damages that Plaintiff seeks to recover in the event of a default judgment, the Court hereby grants leave for Plaintiff to do so.

By no later than August

10, 2026, Plaintiff's Counsel must file either a request for entry of SUBPAC, INC.'s default or a declaration explaining the failure to seek and obtain SUBPAC, INC.'s default, setting forth any and all efforts undertaken to obtain SUBPAC, INC.'s default, and explaining why sanctions (including monetary sanctions of at least \$1,000) should not be imposed for failure to timely seek SUBPAC, INC.'s default, in compliance with California Rules of Court, Rule 3.720. Failure to comply by August 10, 2026 may result in the Court setting an OSC re sanctions.

The parties are to
file a Joint Status Report by no later than September 7, 2026 in
compliance with the Court's initial status conference order. Failure to comply
may result in the court setting an OSC re sanctions

The previously
imposed stay on discovery remains in effect.

The Initial Status
Conference is continued to September 14, 2026 at 8:30 am. The parties are to file a Joint Initial
Status Conference Report by no later than September 7, 2026 in
compliance with the Court's Initial Status Conference order.

Plaintiff's
Counsel is ordered to give notice to all other parties and file proof of
service of such.